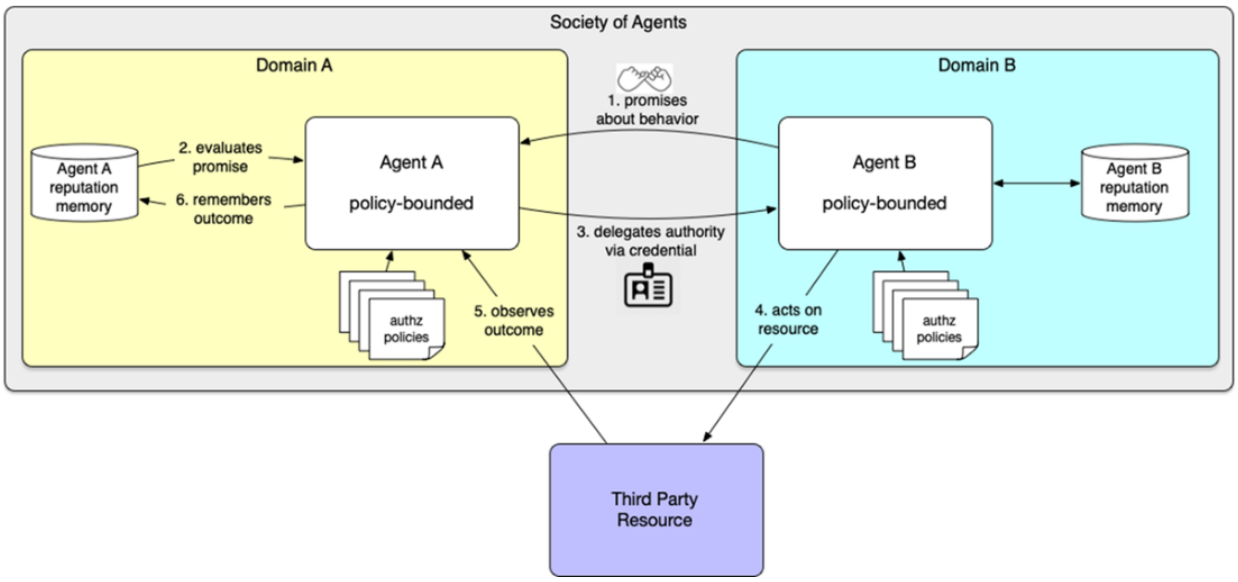


Figure 18.5 Cross-domain delegation in a society of agents. Two policy-limited agents collaborate across different domains. The receiving agent makes promises about its future behavior, the requesting agent assesses those promises and the partner's reputation, and then grants authority using a credential. The receiving agent operates under its own policies, and both domains log the outcome for future decisions.

Once ACME accepts the partner's promise, it delegates authority using a verifiable credential, following the pattern introduced in chapter 16. The credential transports the delegated authority across the organizational boundary so the partner's policy system can assess it. A credential issued by ACME's finance system might look like this: